Mátyás Molnár

PhD Candidate in Economics

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Research Interests

Industrial Policy, International Trade, Economic History, Applied Microeconomics

Education

2022 – 2027	**PhD in Economics**, Central European University, Vienna
2025 – 2026	Visiting PhD Student, LMU, Munich (host: Claudia Steinwender)
2020 – 2022	**MSc in Economics**, Humboldt University, Berlin
2015 – 2016	**MSc in Philosophy of Science**, London School of Economics, London
2012 – 2015	**BSc in Mathematics and Philosophy**, University of York, York

Research

"Finding Buyers: Information and Trade Promotion in the First Globalization" *(Job Market Paper)*
Using a historical quasi-experiment from late nineteenth-century Austria-Hungary, I show that published information about foreign buyers increases the probability of exporting to a destination by 5–14%, identifying buyer information as a key channel through which export promotion raises trade.

"What Happens in Paris, Does Not Stay in Paris: Trade Fairs and Search and Matching Frictions" (with Gábor Békés and Claudia Steinwender)
Exploiting Hungarian firms' participation in the 1900 Paris World Exhibition as a quasi-experiment, we find that trade fair participation raises export probability by 4–10 percentage points, patenting by 4–6 percentage points, and employment by 16–23% over eight years, providing causal evidence that reducing search-and-matching frictions drives firm-level gains from trade.

"Foreign Occupation and National Irredentism: Evidence from Hungary" (with Ricardo Pique)
Using a spatial regression discontinuity design around the Romanian occupation of Hungary after WWI, we show that settlements experiencing more intense military occupation subsequently displayed greater support for nationalist and far-right irredentist movements.

Fellowships, Grants & Awards

2025 – 2028	Doctoral researcher, FWF-DFG project Globalization and Industrial Policy	
2025 – 2026	Doctoral Research Support Grant, Central European University	€5,000
2022 – 2025	PhD Stipend, Central European University	
2015 – 2016	LSE Graduate Bursary	£10,000

Conference and Workshop Presentations

2026: Kiel Institute Industrial Policy Lab Annual Conference (Berlin, forthcoming); CEPR-UCD-Central Bank of Ireland (Dublin, forthcoming); ETSG (Exeter); CESifo Junior Workshop (Munich); Vienna PhD Conference (Vienna); Development Economics Workshop (Vienna); Computational-History Conference (Vienna); KTI Junior Conference (Budapest)

2025: Vienna PhD Conference (Vienna); Helpman Trade Workshop (Vienna); Development Economics Workshop (Vienna); CEPR Text-as-data Conference (Online); LMU Trade Retreat (Munich)

2024: CEPR Paris Symposium (Paris)

Media

VoxTalks at CEPR Paris Symposium 2024 (link)

Teaching Experience

Spring 2026	**Course Instructor** — Industrial Policy in the 21st Century (Undergraduate)
Winter 2025	**Teaching Assistant** — Scientific Python (Graduate)
Spring 2024	**Teaching Assistant** — Machine Learning with Natural Language Processing (Graduate)
Winter 2024	**Teaching Assistant** — Scientific Python (Graduate)
Fall 2023	**Teaching Assistant** — Macroeconomics for Economics Policy (Graduate)

Research Experience

2025 – 2027 **PhD Researcher** to Gábor Békés and Claudia Steinwender
Project: *"Globalization and Industrial Policy"*

2023 – 2024 **Research Assistant** to Gábor Békés
Project: *"Integrators and Robot Adoption: Facts from Hungary"*

Other (non-academic) experience

2019 – 2022	**Software Engineer** at EITCO (Berlin)
2017	**FinTech Analyst Intern** at McKinsey (Budapest)
2016 – 2017	**Business Developer** for Planky (London)

Skills

Software	Large-scale archival digitization, LLM-based information extraction (Python), Stata, LaTeX, QGIS
Languages	English (fluent), Hungarian (native), German (fluent)

References

Gábor Békés
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LMU Munich
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